THE PATIENT TECHNOLOGIST

PT

How I Built My Own AI Agent (And You Can Too)

A gentle, step-by-step guide for creators, beginners and anyone who thinks they "can't do computers."

> *No question is too basic. We go at your pace.*

Tech, taught gently. AI, built in public.
@thepatienttechnologist

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Read one chapter at a time. Each one is short. You don't have to finish in a day. If a chapter has a **Watch** box, there's a matching video on my YouTube channel where you can see me do it on screen.

Green **Calm tip** boxes are for the moments that feel scary. Orange **Careful** boxes are the few things that genuinely matter. Everything else is safe to try.

CHAPTER 00

Before we start: a note from me

I'm not a big-tech engineer. That's exactly why I wrote this.

Hi, I'm The Patient Technologist.

Before any of this, I worked as a personal assistant and administrator for an events and media company. I'm also trained in counselling and special educational needs. I love design and I've taught myself to code, but for a long time I wasn't confident building anything "real."

Then I set up my own AI agent. Not a chatbot I type questions into, but an assistant that lives on my own computer, does research, writes files, remembers what matters to me, and even manages part of my online shop.

Most guides about AI agents are written by developers, for developers. They skip the basics, use words nobody explains, and make you feel like you're behind. This guide is the opposite.

MY PROMISE TO YOU

If tech has ever made you feel stupid: it's not you, it's how it was taught. I'll explain every step in plain words, tell you what each thing does before I ask you to click it, and tell you honestly where I got stuck too.

Who this guide is for

- Creators who want help with research, writing and planning content
- Complete beginners who are curious about AI but nervous
- People with learning differences who need things broken into small steps
- Virtual assistants and freelancers who want to add AI skills to what they offer

What you'll have by the end

- Your own AI agent running on your own computer
- An agent that knows who you are and what you're working towards
- Your first finished piece of work done with its help
- A clear idea of how to grow it into a small team of helpers

CHAPTER 01

What an AI agent actually is

2-minute read · no jargon

A chatbot answers. An agent does.

When you use a normal AI chat, you ask a question and it gives you an answer. Then it's up to you to do something with that answer.

An agent can take actions for you. Depending on what you allow it to do, it can:

- search the web and read pages
- write and save documents on your computer
- remember things about you between conversations
- connect to services you use, like an online shop
- run a job on a schedule, like a weekly report

THE WAY I THINK ABOUT IT

Imagine hiring an assistant. A chatbot is like ringing a clever friend for advice. An agent is like having that friend sitting at a desk in your office, with a computer, a phone and a filing cabinet, ready to actually get things done.

Three words you'll hear

Word	What it means in plain English
Model	The "brain" that does the thinking. Companies like Anthropic and OpenAI make these.
Agent	The assistant that uses the brain plus tools to do tasks for you.
API key	A long secret code that lets one program talk to another. Treat it like a password.

CALM TIP

You don't need to memorise these. There's a short word list at the end of Chapter 12 you can come back to any time.

CHAPTER 02

Why this matters if you create content

Creating content is a lot of jobs pretending to be one job.

When you post online, you're the researcher, writer, editor, designer, marketer, shop owner and admin. That's why so many creators burn out. An agent can take on the parts that drain you, so you keep the parts only you can do: your voice, your story, your face on camera.

What my agent actually does for me

Job	What that looked like for me
Research	It looked into trends, gaps and niches for virtual assistants and freelance coders and wrote me a full report with sources.
Branding	It helped me choose my brand name, write my bio line and set up a booking link.
Platform setup	It wrote my YouTube channel description, banner tagline and my first three video ideas.
Selling	It connected to my Gumroad shop, checked my products, and tidied up a duplicate listing.
Copywriting	A copywriter agent on my crew wrote a book bundle and a launch discount for my shop.
Writing guides	It helped me put together the guide you're reading now.

The bigger reason

Building an agent in public gave me something to post about. Every task I gave it became a video idea. Every problem I solved became a tip for someone else. If you're a creator stuck on "what do I post," **documenting what you build is the answer**.

> CALM TIP
>
> An agent is a helper, not a replacement for you. People follow people. Keep your own voice in everything you publish, and always read what your agent writes before it goes out.

CHAPTER 03

What I used (and what it costs)

Fewer things than you'd think.

Tool	What it does	Cost
StarNet	The "station" where my agent lives and works. It runs on my own computer and shows my agents as a little pixel-art space station.	**Free**
An AI model account	The brain. I connected Claude through Anthropic. You can also use OpenAI, OpenRouter and others.	Pay-as-you-go. I started with **£10 to £20 of Claude credits**
My computer	Where StarNet runs. I use Windows.	Already had it
Gumroad (optional)	My online shop for books and guides. My agent can read it and help manage it.	Free to start; Gumroad takes a fee per sale
Calendly (optional)	My booking link, so people can book a session with me.	Free plan available

> **CAREFUL**
>
> AI model accounts usually charge by how much you use them. When you sign up, look for a spending limit or budget setting and set one. Start small. You can always raise it later.

What you don't need

- A computer science degree
- To know how to code (it helps later, but it's not needed to start)
- An expensive computer
- A big budget

CHAPTER 04

Setting up the station

About 15 minutes

StarNet is the program your agent lives inside. When you open it, you'll see a space station floor, and your first agent standing at a desk. That desk matters. You'll see why in Chapter 06.

1. **Download StarNet.** I got mine here: starnetos.com/docs/getting-started
2. **Run the installer.** Double-click the file you downloaded and follow the steps on screen, the same way you'd install any other app.
3. **Open StarNet.** You'll see the station floor. Along the bottom is a bar called the **dock**. This is where all the main buttons live.
4. **Find COMMS.** This is the chat panel. It's where you type to your agent, like sending a message.
5. **Have a look around.** Don't change anything yet. Just notice the dock, your agent, and the chat.

> CALM TIP
>
> If a window pops up asking whether to allow the app, that's your computer being careful, which is a good thing. Installing StarNet won't break your computer.

> WATCH
>
> See me install it, step by step: youtu.be/kBIVcScfbA0 (my full build video, "How I built my own AI Agent as a total beginner")

The dock, in plain English

Dock group	What's inside
WORK	MY WORK (your tasks and finished deliverables), AUTOMATE (scheduled jobs) and QUESTS
BUILD	BUILD MODE (design your station), CONNECT (link apps and services) and NEW APP
CREW	AGENTS (your team), RECRUIT (hire new agents) and YOU (your own profile)

CHAPTER 05

Giving your agent a brain

About 10 minutes · the one technical bit

Right now your agent has a body but no brain. The brain is the AI model. You connect it once and you're done.

1. **Pick a provider.** I used Anthropic. Other options include OpenAI, OpenRouter, or signing in with ChatGPT.
2. **Make an account** on that provider's website and add a small amount of credit, with a spending limit.
3. **Get your key.** On the provider's website, find the section called API keys and create a new key. It's a long string of letters and numbers. Copy it.
4. **In StarNet, open SETTINGS, then AI & MODELS.** Choose your provider and paste the key in (or sign in, if that's an option).
5. **Test it.** Go to COMMS and type: "*Hello, can you hear me?*" If your agent replies, the brain is connected.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> Your model key goes in **SETTINGS, then AI & MODELS**. Keys for other apps (like your shop) go somewhere else: **CONNECT, then ABILITIES**. I'll show you that in Chapter 10. Never paste a key into the chat window.

> **CALM TIP**
>
> This is where most people feel out of their depth. That's normal. Take it slowly, one step at a time. If the agent doesn't reply, check you pasted the whole key with no spaces at the start or end.

> **WATCH**
>
> See me connect the brain: youtu.be/kBIVcScfbA0 (my full build video, "How I built my own AI Agent as a total beginner")

CHAPTER 06

Building your agent's world

This is my favourite part. The room you build is the power you give.

In StarNet, every agent has a room on the station. **The objects in its room decide what it's allowed to do.** If there's no object for something, the agent can't do it. I love this because you can literally see what your agent can and can't do.

Put this in the room...	...and your agent gets	In real life that means
Workstation (a desk or console)	Thinking power	It can work at all. Every agent needs its own.
Dish	The web	It can search and read websites
Intel cab (a filing cabinet)	Files	It can read and save documents
Workbench	A terminal	It can run commands and test code
Server cart	Memory	It remembers things about you long-term
Studio	Images	It can make and look at pictures

How to add objects

1. Open **BUILD MODE** from the dock.
2. Choose your agent's room.
3. Place the objects you want it to have.
4. Leave BUILD MODE. Your agent now has those powers.

WHAT I GAVE MINE

A workstation, a dish, a filing cabinet and a server cart to start. That's enough for research, writing and remembering. I added the workbench later, when I wanted it to help with code.

CALM TIP

Start with fewer powers, not more. It's easier to understand an agent that can do four things well. You can always add more later.

WATCH

See me build my agent's room: youtu.be/kBIVcScfbA0 (my full build video, "How I built my own AI Agent as a total beginner")

CHAPTER 07

Telling your agent who you are

An agent that knows you gives you work that sounds like you.

Each agent has a **dossier**. Two parts matter most at the start:

- **Purpose**: what you want this agent to help you achieve
- **Context**: who you are, your background, your goals

Open **CREW, then AGENTS**, choose your agent, and fill these in. Write like you're talking to a new assistant on their first day. Spelling doesn't matter. Honesty does.

What I wrote (roughly)

MY PURPOSE

"Write books and guides and make resources that will sell. I'd like to make guides and resources helping people to code, create their own projects and build their own agents."

MY CONTEXT

"I want a coding career where I help people. I'm qualified in counselling, coding, special educational needs, fitness and wellbeing, and psychology and criminology. I want to build a brand helping people virtually. I enjoy design and coding but I'm not confident building things for people yet. I want to learn and eventually make money from projects I've built."

Fill in your own

PURPOSE TEMPLATE

```
I want you to help me [main goal]. The things I make are for [who]. Success looks like [what you'd see if it worked].
```

CONTEXT TEMPLATE

```
I'm [who you are]. My background is [jobs, training, life experience]. I'm good at [strengths]. I struggle with [honest bit]. Right now I'm working on [current projects]. Please talk to me [how you like to be spoken to].
```

CALM TIP

That last line matters, especially if you have a learning difference. You can write "please use short sentences" or "one step at a time, please." Your agent will follow it.

CHAPTER 08

My first real tasks (word for word)

You don't need special "prompt" skills. Just ask like a person.

Here's what I actually typed into COMMS in my first sessions, and what I got back. My spelling wasn't perfect and it didn't matter.

Task 1: Research

WHAT I TYPED

```
I want to build a virtual assistant career and a coding freelancer career, but I'm struggling as a newbie. Can you look into trends right now and gaps and niches?
```

What I got: a full report saved as a file, with links to every source. It showed that specialist, AI-skilled assistants are in demand and that my mix of admin, counselling and SEN experience was a gap almost nobody fills. That's where "The Patient Technologist" came from.

Task 2: Brand

WHAT I TYPED

```
Help me set up one social media please. Brand name, bio line, booking link.
```

What I got: a brand name with backups, a bio under 150 characters, and a ten-minute walkthrough to set up a free booking page.

Task 3: YouTube

WHAT I TYPED

```
What about YouTube description and profile on there?
```

What I got: a paste-ready channel description, a banner tagline, a setup checklist and three first video ideas. The first one became this guide.

WHAT I LEARNED

Short, honest requests work. When the answer wasn't quite right, I just said so, like "focus on X instead," and it adjusted. Treat it like a conversation, not a magic spell.

Everything your agent makes is kept in **MY WORK, then DELIVERABLES**, so you never lose it.

WATCH

See these first tasks live: youtu.be/kBIVcScfbA0 (my full build video, "How I built my own AI Agent as a total beginner")

CHAPTER 09

Hiring a crew

One agent is an assistant. A few agents is a small team.

Once my first agent was working well, I hired specialists. My first agent became the lead (the overseer). It hands jobs to the right crew member and checks the results before I see them.

How to hire

1. Open **CREW, then RECRUIT**. This takes you to the Recruitment Bay.
2. Pick a specialist class, like a copywriter or marketer. Or build your own custom class.
3. The new agent appears on your station. Give it a workstation in BUILD MODE so it can work.
4. Fill in its purpose, just like you did in Chapter 07.

My crew

Name	Role	What they've done for me
My lead agent	Overseer	Research, planning, brand kits, shop management, and handing out jobs
Quill	Copywriter	Wrote a three-book bundle, a launch discount code and new closing lines for my book listings
Beacon	Marketer	Works out which channel to focus on and how to work it

CALM TIP

Don't hire a big team on day one. Add a crew member only when you notice the same kind of job coming up again and again. That's your sign.

WATCH

See me hire my crew: youtu.be/kBIVcScfbA0 (my full build video, "How I built my own AI Agent as a total beginner")

CHAPTER 10

Connecting my shop so the agent can help me earn

This is where it stopped being a toy and started being a business tool.

I sell my books and guides on Gumroad. I wanted my agent to see my products and sales and help me manage them. Here's exactly how I connected it, including the part that confused me.

1. **In Gumroad,** go to Settings, then Advanced, and find the section for creating an application.
2. **Give it a name**, like "My Agent."
3. **The confusing bit:** Gumroad asks for a **Redirect URI**. I had no idea what to put. Type **http://127.0.0.1**. When the app is only for you, Gumroad doesn't really use it.
4. **Click Create application,** then click **Generate access token**. Copy the token.
5. **In StarNet, open CONNECT, then ABILITIES.** Type "Gumroad" into the search box. If there's no ready-made card, go to **INSTALLED, then SAVED API CONNECTIONS** and paste the token there.
6. **Test it.** In COMMS, ask: "*What can I do with my Gumroad store?*"

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT

My agent read my whole store: ten products, which ones were live, and my sales so far. It spotted an unpublished duplicate of one of my books. It checked it against the live copy, confirmed it was safe, asked me first, then deleted it.

It also noticed some of my listings said "completely free" when they actually cost money. Small things like that cost you trust and sales.

CAREFUL

Some shops limit what an agent can do. On Gumroad, my agent can read and update things, but it can't create brand-new product listings. So it writes the listing words and I paste them in. That's fine. Knowing the limit saves you frustration.

CALM TIP

The same method works for lots of apps. If an app gives you an API key, you can usually save it in CONNECT, then ABILITIES, and your agent can use it.

WATCH

See me connect my shop: youtu.be/kBIVcScfbA0 (my full build video, "How I built my own AI Agent as a total beginner")

CHAPTER 11

Staying safe: keys, passwords and good habits

I made one mistake here so you don't have to.

MY HONEST MISTAKE

When I first got my Gumroad token, I pasted it straight into the chat with my agent. It worked, but my agent pointed out that a key sitting in chat isn't safe. I moved it to CONNECT, then ABILITIES, where it's stored properly, and the agent uses it from there without ever seeing the actual code.

My five safety rules

1. **Keys never go in the chat.** Model keys go in SETTINGS, then AI & MODELS. App keys go in CONNECT, then ABILITIES.
2. **Never share a key in a screenshot or video.** Blur it, or make a new key after filming.
3. **If a key gets seen, replace it.** Go back to the app, delete the old key, make a new one.
4. **Set spending limits** on your AI model account.
5. **Check before anything permanent.** Deleting, sending emails, publishing. Ask your agent to tell you what it's about to do first.

Choosing how much freedom to give

Each agent has a permission setting:

- **Approval mode**: the agent asks you with a one-click prompt before it saves files, runs commands or goes online. If something seems stuck, check the **APPROVALS** spot (press Alt and A). It might be waiting for you.
- **Full power**: the agent can act on your computer without asking.

CALM TIP

Start in approval mode. Clicking "approve" a few times teaches you what your agent actually does. Move to more freedom once you trust it.

CHAPTER 12

When you get stuck

You will get stuck. I did. Here's what fixed it.

What's happening	Try this
My agent says **NO COMPUTE** or won't run	Its room has no workstation. Open BUILD MODE and put a desk or console in its room.
It can't search the web	Put a dish in its room.
It can't read or save files	Put a filing cabinet (intel cab) in its room.
It doesn't reply at all	Check the model key in SETTINGS, then AI & MODELS. Then make sure you clicked on the right agent before typing.
It seems frozen mid-task	Check the APPROVALS spot (Alt and A). It may be waiting for your yes.
I can't find my agent	They walk around when idle. Click their name in the crew list to find them.
I want it to use an app I use	Open CONNECT, then ABILITIES, and search the app's name.
I can't find something it made	Look in MY WORK, then DELIVERABLES.

Word list

Word	Plain meaning
Model	The AI brain
Agent	An assistant that uses the brain plus tools to do things
API key / token	A secret code that lets two apps talk. Treat it like a password.
Prompt	What you type to your agent
Deliverable	A finished thing your agent made, like a report or file
Routine	A job your agent does on a schedule
Crew	Your team of agents

STILL STUCK?

That's normal, and it's exactly what I'm here for. Book a patient one-to-one session and we'll go through it together, at your pace: calendly.com/thepatienttechnologist/patient-tech-session

CHAPTER 13

Your copy-and-paste prompt pack

Ten things to ask your agent this week. Change the bits in brackets.

1 · GET TO KNOW YOUR NICHE

```
Look into what's trending right now for [your topic]. What are people asking for that nobody is answering well? Save it as a report with sources.
```

2 · NAME AND BIO

```
Help me set up my [platform] profile. Give me a brand name, 3 backups, and a bio under 150 characters for people who [who you help].
```

3 · A MONTH OF IDEAS

```
Give me 30 short video ideas about [topic] for beginners. Group them into weeks and give each one a hook for the first 3 seconds.
```

4 · SCRIPT A VIDEO

```
Write a 60-second script about [topic]. Use short sentences, plain words and one clear takeaway. It should sound like me, not like an advert.
```

5 · REPURPOSE

```
Turn this [video transcript / post] into a carousel, a caption and 3 short tweets. Keep my voice. [paste it]
```

6 · CHECK MY SHOP

```
Look at my [shop] and tell me what's live, what's hidden, what's selling, and the three quickest fixes to sell more.
```

7 · WRITE A LISTING

```
Write a product listing for [product] for [who it's for]. Include a title, a one-line promise, what's inside, and who it's NOT for.
```

8 · WEEKLY REPORT

```
Every Monday at 9am, check my [shop / channel] and send me a short summary of what changed and one thing to try this week.
```

9 · EXPLAIN IT GENTLY

```
Explain [confusing thing] to me like I'm brand new. One step at a time, and check I'm okay before moving on.
```

10 · BE HONEST WITH ME

```
Read this and tell me honestly what's working and what isn't. Don't just be nice. [paste your work]
```

CALM TIP

Prompt 8 sets up a routine, a job your agent does on its own schedule. You can see and pause your routines any time in AUTOMATE, then SCHEDULES.

CHAPTER 14

Your checklist and what's next

Tick these off as you go

- [ ] StarNet installed and open
- [ ] Model connected in SETTINGS, then AI & MODELS, with a spending limit set
- [ ] Agent replied to "Hello, can you hear me?"
- [ ] Workstation, dish, filing cabinet and server cart placed in its room
- [ ] Purpose and context written in its dossier
- [ ] First real task done and found in MY WORK, then DELIVERABLES
- [ ] (Optional) First crew member hired
- [ ] (Optional) One app connected in CONNECT, then ABILITIES
- [ ] No keys anywhere in chat
- [ ] Celebrated. Seriously. You built an AI agent.

What I'd do next

1. **Post about it.** Film yourself doing one task with your agent. That's your first piece of content.
2. **Give it one recurring job.** A weekly summary is a great first routine.
3. **Turn what you made into something you can share or sell.** A checklist, a template, a mini-guide. This guide started exactly that way.

Want help doing this?

I offer patient one-to-one tech sessions for beginners, creators and people who learn differently. No question is too basic. We go at your pace.

Book a session: calendly.com/thepatienttechnologist/patient-tech-session
More books and guides: **serenfund.gumroad.com**
Instagram and YouTube: **@thepatienttechnologist**

Go gently. You've got this.
The Patient Technologist

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